France — Switzerland: Bilateral Overview (Services & Macro Context)

Executive briefing for EDA/AIDA | Coverage: 2015–2027 (IMF forecasts for 2026–2027; WTO services trade to 2024)

Task Bilateral Overview | **Countries** FRA | **Question** France

Executive Summary

France remains a major, high-income neighbouring market for Switzerland and a significant counterpart in bilateral services trade. Available WTO data indicate Switzerland imported more services from France than it exported in 2024, implying a services trade deficit in that year. IMF projections suggest a stable but low-growth macro environment in France through 2027, with inflation easing but public debt rising—relevant for Swiss firms' market planning and for monitoring potential fiscal and regulatory implications.

Key Points

- Bilateral services trade is sizable; in 2024 Switzerland was a net importer of services from France (imports exceeded exports).
- France's outlook is for modest real GDP growth (0.9% projected in 2026–2027), implying limited cyclical momentum but continued market scale.
- Inflation is projected to remain lower than the 2022–2023 peak (1.7% forecast for 2027), improving cost and demand predictability.
- Public debt is high and projected to rise further (120.5% of GDP by 2027), a medium-term watchpoint for fiscal and regulatory developments relevant to Swiss economic interests.

- Unemployment is elevated by Swiss standards (7.9% projected in 2026–2027), providing context for domestic demand and policy pressures.

Headline Metrics

CH→FR SERVICES EXPORTS (WTO)

USD 13,653 million

2024 (balanced values)

CH←FR SERVICES IMPORTS (WTO)

USD 16,717 million

2024 (balanced values); imports exceed exports

REAL GDP GROWTH (IMF)

0.9%

2027 forecast (annual %)

INFLATION (IMF)

1.7%

2027 forecast (average consumer prices, annual %)

GOVERNMENT GROSS DEBT (IMF)

120.5% of GDP

2027 forecast

UNEMPLOYMENT (IMF)

7.9%

2027 forecast

Bilateral services trade (Switzerland–France)

WTO balanced values point to a large bilateral services relationship, with Switzerland importing more services from France than it exports. In 2024, Swiss services exports to France were USD 13,653 million versus imports of USD 16,717 million, indicating Switzerland was a net importer of services from France in that year. For Swiss stakeholders, this underscores France's continued importance as both a destination market and a source of services inputs, with implications for cross-border business conditions and sectoral competitiveness.

Macroeconomic outlook in France (IMF projections)

IMF projections indicate a stable but low-growth environment: real GDP growth is forecast at 0.9% in 2026–2027 (after 1.1% in 2024 and 0.9% in 2025). Despite modest growth, France's market scale remains large in nominal terms (nominal GDP projected at USD 3,672.073 billion in 2027; GDP per capita projected at USD 53,035 in 2027). For Swiss economic engagement, this suggests a mature market with continued purchasing power but limited cyclical tailwinds.

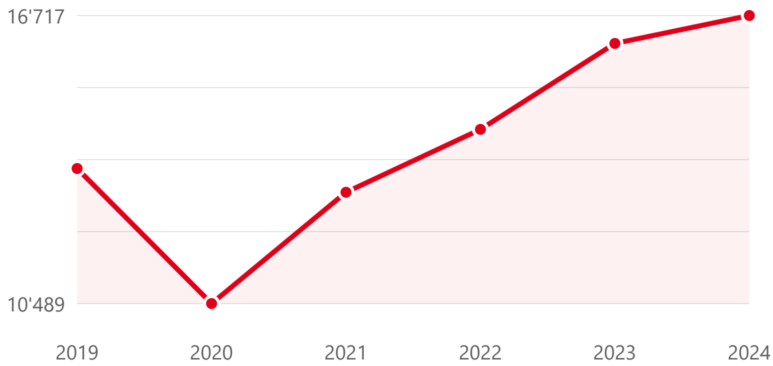
Price stability and fiscal trajectory: implications to monitor

Inflation is projected to ease markedly compared with 2022–2023 (5.9% and 5.7%), reaching 2.3% in 2024 and 1.7% by 2027. This supports more predictable operating conditions for Swiss exporters and service providers. At the same time, public debt is high and projected to increase (from 109.6% of GDP in 2023 to 120.5% by 2027). This debt trajectory is a relevant medium-term watchpoint for potential shifts in fiscal policy, taxation, and regulatory measures that could affect Swiss commercial interests.

EVIDENCE VISUALS

Trend: France - Services imports: balanced values

Automatically selected because the evidence includes a consistent multi-year time series. — Million US dollar



DATA CAVEATS

- No bilateral FDI indicators are available in the evidence pack (SNB-related series listed as missing); no Switzerland–France FDI assessment is included.
- IMF services aggregates in the pack are missing (e.g., bopserva_total and bopserva_share); bilateral services discussion relies on WTO balanced values.
- IMF values for 2026–2027 are forecasts; WTO bilateral services trade data in this pack are available only up to 2024.
- Services figures are presented in current USD and may be affected by exchange-rate movements; the pack does not provide volume measures or sectoral breakdowns.

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Generated for the Swiss Federal Department of Foreign Affairs (EDA). This report is derived from the current analytical answer and the structured evidence pack provided by AIDA.